

Keep an error log with actionable causes

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

An error log is useful when it groups mistakes by causes you can train: missed checks, loose pieces, weak pawn breaks, or poor time allocation. Labels such as 'played badly' provide no next action. Keep entries brief and specific.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If three games feature the same missed back-rank idea, practice that pattern and add a flight-square scan to your move habit. If losses come from isolated-pawn endings, review exchanges and king activity in that structure.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What makes an error-log entry actionable?

ANSWER AND REASONING

It identifies the position, the missed resource, the reason you missed it, and one practice task. Revisit the entry after several games to see whether the habit improved.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Turn a mistake into a repeatable training action.